

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE
5 FOR
6 HOUSE BILL NO. 4427

By: Hilbert, Pogemiller, and
 Provenzano of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

11 COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

12 An Act relating to adjunct teachers; amending Section
13 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025,
14 Section 6-122.12), which relates to adjunct teachers;
15 authorizing public and charter school district to
16 hire adjunct teachers who are persons with
17 distinguished qualifications in their field;
18 directing the State Board of Education to promulgate
19 rules defining distinguished qualifications;
20 requiring adjunct teachers without a baccalaureate
21 degree to meet certain requirements; prohibiting
22 adjunct teachers from teaching core curriculum
23 subjects in pre-kindergarten through fourth grade
24 beginning with the 2026-2027 school year; permitting
 previously employed adjunct teachers to continue to
 teach core curriculum subjects in pre-kindergarten
 through fourth grade if granted a waiver from the
 State Board of Education; prohibiting an adjunct
 teacher from teaching more than five years unless he
 or she holds a teaching certificate, has completed
 the requirements to become certified, or is on a
 pathway to become certified within two years;
 clarifying status of adjunct who does not hold a
 valid certificate to teach; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
 Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162,
 Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section

6-122.3), which relates to alternative placement teaching certificate; removing adjunct teacher language; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), is amended to read as follows:

Section 6-122.12. A. Public and charter school districts in Oklahoma shall be authorized to hire adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished qualifications in their field. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules defining distinguished qualifications.

B. Adjunct teachers without a baccalaureate degree shall:

1. Be enrolled in a baccalaureate degree program with an estimated completion of less than two (2) years and shall provide proof of satisfactory completion of coursework to his or her employing school district and the State Board of Education each semester; or

2. Have a minimum of twenty (20) years of verifiable, distinguished experience in the subject matter in which the person will be employed as an adjunct teacher to instruct.

C. 1. Beginning with the 2026-2027 school year, adjunct teachers shall not teach in core curriculum subjects, such as math,

1 English language arts, science, or social studies in pre-
2 kindergarten through fourth grade.

3 2. If a public or charter school district employed an adjunct
4 teacher to teach core curriculum classes in pre-kindergarten through
5 fourth grade prior to the 2026-2027 school year, the school district
6 may apply for a waiver to the State Board of Education. To be
7 eligible to apply for a waiver, the adjunct teacher shall have:

8 a. previously taught core curriculum classes in pre-
9 kindergarten through fourth grade, and

10 b. completed professional development training in the
11 science of reading.

12 If the waiver is granted by the State Board, the school district
13 may continue to employ the adjunct teacher to teach core curriculum
14 classes in pre-kindergarten through fourth grade.

15 D. An adjunct teacher shall not teach longer than five (5)
16 years unless he or she meets the following criteria:

17 1. Holds a valid teaching certificate;

18 2. Has completed the requirements to receive an alternate or
19 standard teaching certificate; or

20 3. Is on a pathway to complete alternative or standard
21 certification within the next two (2) years. If certification is
22 not achieved within two (2) years, the adjunct teacher shall no
23 longer be employed as an adjunct teacher.

1 E. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this
2 section who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be
3 considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

4 F. The State Department of Education shall publish an annual
5 report on the status of adjunct teachers, authorized by Section 6-
6 122.3 of ~~Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes~~ this title, in this
7 state. The report shall include:

8 1. Qualifications adopted by the State Board of Education to
9 determine eligibility of adjunct teacher candidates;

10 2. The subject areas or courses in which adjunct teachers are
11 teaching; and

12 3. The types of distinguished qualifications adjunct teachers
13 have to make them qualified to teach in certain subject areas or
14 courses.

15 ~~B.~~ G. The annual report shall be published on the website of
16 the State Department of Education and copies of the report shall be
17 provided to ~~elected~~ members of the Oklahoma House of Representatives
18 and the Oklahoma State Senate no later than January 15 of each year.

19 SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as
20 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
21 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

22 Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant
23 an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes
24 application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

- 1 1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
2 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
3 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
4 attained a retention grade point average of not less
5 than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or
6 b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as
7 a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education,
8 professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree
9 or a master of library science degree, from an
10 institution accredited by a national or regional
11 accrediting agency which is recognized by the
12 Secretary of the United States Department of
13 Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
14 Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal
15 degrees, or
16 c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
17 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
18 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
19 qualified work experience in a field that corresponds
20 to an area of certification as determined by the State
21 Board of Education, and
22 d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b
23 and c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency
24 or completed a major in a field that corresponds to an

1 area of specialization for an Elementary-Secondary
2 Certificate or a Secondary Certificate as determined
3 by the State Board of Education or a vocational-
4 technical certificate as recommended by the Oklahoma
5 Department of Career and Technology Education;

6 2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by
7 means of an alternative placement program in not more than three (3)
8 years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject
9 matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the
10 professional education component for each person making application
11 for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the
12 criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

13 The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of
14 six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of
15 eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock
16 hours for the professional education component.

17 The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all
18 student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of
19 subsection E of this section;

20 3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency
21 examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of
22 specialization for which certification is sought; and

23 4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school
24 district in this state offering employment in the area of

1 specialization for which certification is sought on condition that
2 the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by
3 the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek
4 employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in
5 this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection
6 shall be considered a "valid certificate of qualification" for the
7 purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this title, and the holder
8 of the certificate shall be considered an inductee for the purposes
9 of Section 6-195 of this title.

10 B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be
11 renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon
12 presentation of a document from an accredited public school district
13 in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of
14 specialization and a document from a teacher education institution
15 verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative
16 placement program.

17 C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

18 1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education
19 program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education,
20 the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools and by the
21 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation to offer teacher
22 education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed
23 courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of
24 the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

1 2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an
2 Oklahoma institution of higher education a plan for meeting standard
3 certification requirements within three (3) years; and

4 3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section
5 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as
6 other inductees.

7 D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the
8 requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an
9 individual of specific competency in the subject area of
10 specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The
11 State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant
12 exceptions.

13 E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the
14 Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an
15 exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination
16 for initial certification in a field which does not require an
17 advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an
18 advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the
19 content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be
20 from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting
21 agency which is recognized by the Secretary of the U.S. Department
22 of Education. The Commission shall provide the Board with the
23 necessary information to determine comparability.

1 F. Student teaching and a ~~pre-student~~ pre-student teaching field
2 experience shall not be required of alternative placement program
3 participants for standard certification.

4 ~~G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules~~
5 ~~authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished~~
6 ~~qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be~~
7 ~~required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an~~
8 ~~adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a~~
9 ~~valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as~~
10 ~~defined by Section 1-116 of this title.~~

11 ~~H.~~ Each teacher education institution shall provide the
12 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation an annual report of
13 information as specified by the Commission regarding participation
14 in the alternative placement programs offered by the institution.

15 ~~I.~~ H. The Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation shall not
16 accredit, renew the accreditation of, or otherwise approve any
17 teacher education program of any institution of higher education in
18 this state that has not implemented alternative placement programs
19 in at least four areas of specialization, including mathematics,
20 science, and a foreign language. Each institution shall allow
21 individuals who meet the criteria of subsections A and C of this
22 section to be:

23 1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further
24 qualification; and

1 2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for
2 standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section
3 during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year
4 of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any
5 person seeking standard certification through an alternative
6 placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses
7 during regular semesters if offered.

8 ~~¶~~ I. The criteria specified in subsection ~~¶~~ H of this section
9 can be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two or
10 more institutions of higher education.

11 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

12 SECTION 4. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
13 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
14 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
15 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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17 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON EDUCATION OVERSIGHT, dated
18 03/03/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended and Coauthored.
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